

Lexonomy tutorial

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Introduction

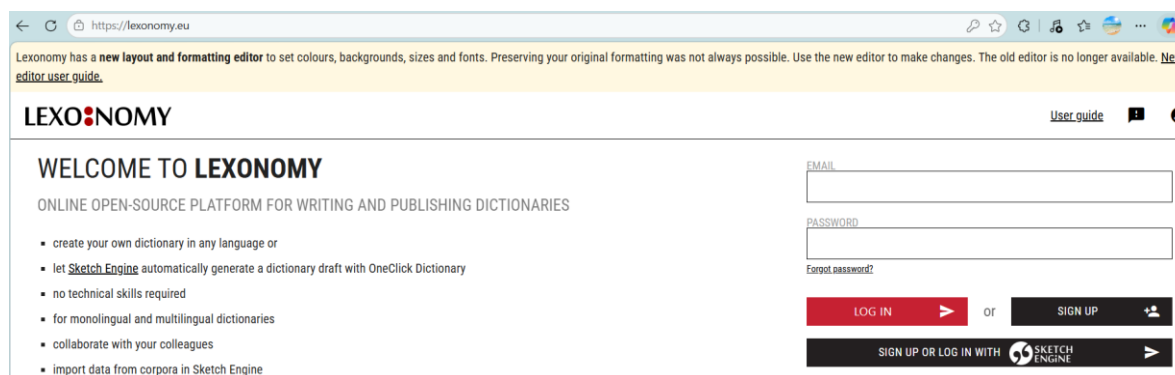
Lexonomy is an online dictionary writing and publishing tool that allows you to create, edit, and share dictionaries easily. It supports structured lexical data, including XML imports (such as files exported from FLE_x), and provides both simple and advanced editing environments. This guide walks you through creating a dictionary, importing data, editing entries, and using key features.

1. Create an Account

Go to the Lexonomy website ([Lexonomy](https://lexonomy.eu)) and:

Sign up for a new account

Log in using your credentials

A screenshot of the Lexonomy website's login and sign-up interface. The browser address bar shows 'https://lexonomy.eu'. A yellow banner at the top contains a message about a new layout and formatting editor. The main header features the 'LEXONOMY' logo and a 'User guide' link. The page is divided into two columns. The left column, titled 'WELCOME TO LEXONOMY', describes the platform as an 'ONLINE OPEN-SOURCE PLATFORM FOR WRITING AND PUBLISHING DICTIONARIES' and lists five bullet points: creating a dictionary in any language, using Sketch Engine for automatic drafts, no technical skills required, support for monolingual and multilingual dictionaries, and collaboration with colleagues. The right column contains input fields for 'EMAIL' and 'PASSWORD', a 'Forgot password?' link, and two buttons: 'LOG IN' and 'SIGN UP'. At the bottom of the right column is a button that says 'SIGN UP OR LOG IN WITH SKETCH ENGINE'.

2. Create a New Dictionary

After logging in:

Click **Create New Dictionary**

You will see three options:

Add dictionary from a template

Upload entries

Custom dictionary

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ADD DICTIONARY



From a template

Start with one of the ready-made templates for the most frequent types of dictionaries. You can customize, add or remove elements as required.



Upload entries

Upload an existing dictionary in the NVH or XML formats.



Custom dictionary

For expert users. Start from scratch by creating your own entry structure.

3. Import Data from FLEx (XML)

If you already have a dictionary in FLEx, this is the easiest method.

Step 1: Export XML from FLEx

In FLEx:

Go to **File** → **Export** → **XML**

This creates an XML file containing your lexical data.

The screenshot shows the Varkani dictionary1 - FieldWorks Language Explorer interface. The main window displays a list of dictionary entries under the heading "Main Dictionary Entries". The entries are listed in a table with columns for the word, its part of speech, and its meaning. The entries are sorted by the word "a" and include words like "abande", "abare", "abaxše", "abi", "abrü", "äcadenda", "äcašd", "äcašdä", "äcašdanda", "äcašdawn", "äcašdayda", "äcašdayi", "äcašdayma", "äcašde bēda", "äcašde bi", "äcašde bida", "äcašde bima", "äcašde bo", "äcašde bodda", "äcašde bodenda", "äcašde bodma", "äcašde bodun", "äcašde bu", and "äcašde bun".

An "Export" dialog box is open, showing the "Data" and "Format" tabs. The "Data" tab is selected, and the "Format" dropdown is set to "XML". The "About the selected export method:" section provides instructions on how to use the exported XML file. The "Export..." button is highlighted.

Step 2: Upload XML to Lexonomy

In Lexonomy:

Choose **Upload entries**

Select your exported XML file

Lexonomy will import your entries automatically.

This method is efficient because your word list is already structured and only requires minor customization.

LEXO:NOMY

[Dictionaries](#) [User guide](#)  

 > [DICTIONARIES](#)

YOUR DICTIONARIES

🔍

×

Title ↑

 PUBLIC DICTIONARIES

+ CREATE NEW DICTIONARY

Language Size Last edit

LEXO:NOMY

 > [DICTIONARIES](#) > NEW DICTIONARY

← UPLOAD OWN DATA

DICTIONARY NAME

Varkani Dictionary

You will be able to change this later.

MAIN LANGUAGE *

English

You will be able to change this later.

FILE WITH ENTRIES IN NVH  OR XML FORMAT

CHOOSE FILE

varkani_ID_1_928.xml

ENTRY ELEMENT *

entry

HEADWORD ELEMENT *

form/orth

4. Editing entries (Editor mode)

Switch to editing mode

Click the **pencil icon** or press **Alt + 2**

Activate editing with **Alt + Ctrl + Click** on an entry

- **How to edit an entry**

Use arrow keys to select an element

Press **Enter** to start editing

Type your content

Press **Enter** again to save

- **Navigation and Saving**

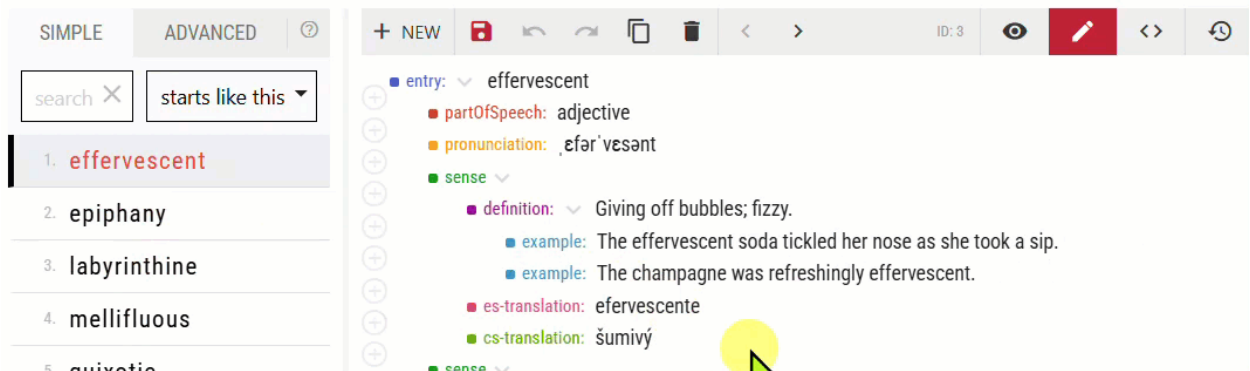
Move between elements using arrow keys

Press **Ctrl + S** to save the entry

Press **Ctrl + Enter** to save and move to the next entry

Adding new elements

Click the **(+) plus icon** to add new fields (e.g., POS, translation)



I got the above image from this website: [Entry writing - Lexonomy Guide](#)

5. Configure dictionary settings

To modify settings:

Go to **Dictionary** → **Configure** → **Publish**

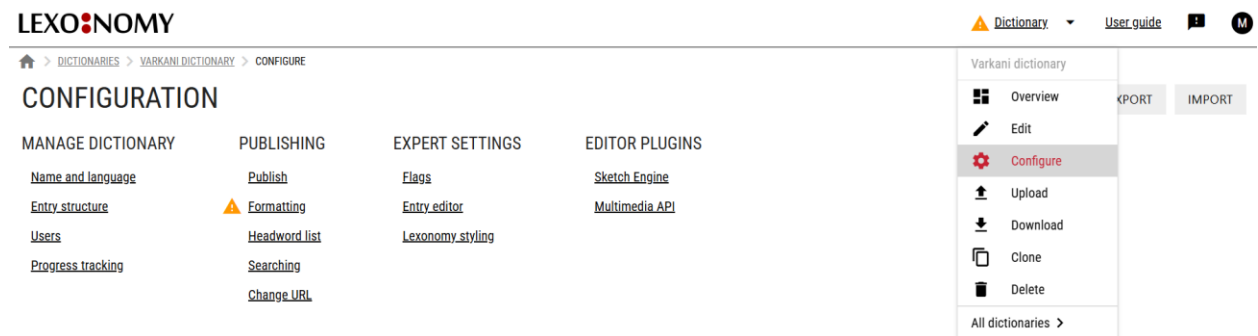
Here you can:

Set your dictionary as **Public** or **Private**

Private: requires login to access

Public: accessible to anyone

For most projects, a **public dictionary** is recommended.



6. Searching for Words

Basic Search

Steps:

Click inside the search box

Type a word (e.g., *ašg*)

Press **Enter**

Result:

Displays entries containing that string

- **Search Types (Important)**

Next to the search bar, you will see:

 **contains**

You can change it to:

contains → finds matches anywhere (recommended for beginners)

starts with → faster and more precise

equals → exact match only

7. Advanced Search

Click **Advanced** to access more powerful search options.

You can search by specific fields:

- headword
- definition
- translation
- part of speech (POS)
- Example:
- pos = noun

This will return all noun entries.

8. Browsing Entries

- **Random Access**

Click any entry number (e.g., 191)

The corresponding entry will open

- **Open Full Editor**

Click:

 **Open in Editor**

This allows you to:

Scroll through all entries

Edit systematically

Navigate efficiently

9. Editing Entries (Direct Editing)

Inside the editor:

Click any field

Type directly to modify content

You can edit:

- Headword
- Translation
- Part of speech (POS)
- Domain or semantic field

10. Managing Your Dictionary

Whenever you want to edit your dictionary:

Log in to Lexonomy

Go to the main dashboard

You will see:

- A list of your dictionaries
- Last modification date
- Number of entries

From there, you can reopen and continue editing your work.



11 Link Lexonomy to GitHub

This is the simplest and most correct method.

Get your Lexonomy dictionary link

Open your dictionary in Lexonomy.

Copy the URL, for example:

<https://www.lexonomy.eu/dictionary/your-dictionary-name>